

GAME416 - Data Driven Design
Final Assignment
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Concept of a project

Cuneiform is one of the earliest writing systems used to record, store, and transmit information. Appearing in Mesopotamia around 3200 BC, it was used for almost three millennia before gradually disappearing by the 1st century AD. Thousands of preserved clay tablets were deciphered, which revealed records of trade, administration, literature, religion, and personal correspondence.

For this project, I was interested in cuneiform as one of the early methods of data preservation and transmission. I started by studying examples of translated cuneiform tablets to better understand what types of information are usually documented. I discovered that cuneiform is not an alphabet in the modern sense, but rather a writing system consisting mainly of syllabic and logographic signs, the meanings of which can vary depending on the context and language. Since accurate linguistic transliteration would require knowledge of languages such as Sumerian or Akkadian, I instead focused on modern educational resources designed to study and reproduce Cuneiform characters.

I compared several online cuneiform diagrams and transliteration guides and chose a reference book in a modern alphabetic style that provided the clearest one-to-one correspondence between Latin letters and cuneiform characters. Although this approach does not reproduce historical writing methods with complete accuracy, it has allowed me to reinterpret my own text using the visual language of Cuneiform and explore how modern information can be encoded using one of the oldest known writing systems.

Since I'm using alphabetic style, the text will be very long. Often cuneiform texts were letters, so I wrote a short text in a form of a letter. I wanted to leave it pretty modern to have a comparison between old texts and how we talk today.

"To my friend,

Give me my fifty tl back. I am planning to cook yummy dinner. I brought like one bread and a kitkat so I need my money back. I still have 2 exams I hope you are still sane and well. Do not forget about money."





